

Plasto & Company
Livestock and Property

Livestock
Ross Plasto
0428 636 289

Property Management
Emma Cenzato
0418 636 254

Raine and Horne
Residential & Rural Properties
Gary Francis
0428 459 830

Wellington & District
LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucareena, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbon and Yeoval districts.

\$2.50
Inc GST

No. 238
THURSDAY, June 25 2026
ISSN 2653-2026

Established August, 2021

WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

Racing at Wellington Thursday August 13
Full TAB -7-race card
It's a great day out!!

Shop Local
Grow Local
- P3

Geurie demands new bridge action - P 4

'ONE STOP SHOP' DIRECTORY
Straight to your email Each Thursday
WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

Need a Tradie or local service? - P 11

Rotary's new team

Beth Hattenfels hands-over presidency to Shaun Leggett

BETH HATTENFELS finalised her presidency of the Rotary Club of Wellington last Saturday evening with several presentations during the club's annual board Changeover dinner.

Among awards at Wellington Golf Club Beth presented Bill Redfern for 41-years' service to Rotary, Michael White for 40-years' service to Rotary and to Jennifer Wykes for four continuous years as Secretary of the Club.

Another highlight of the evening was a well-deserved Paul Harris Fellow awarded to a very hard-working Ray Pulbrook.

Paul Harris was the founder of Rotary International and this award named after him is considered very prestigious.

As well, Beth Hattenfels inducted the newest member into the Club - Prof. Nadira Tidwell, who has been in Rotary for more than 30 years, serving on various Boards and setting up Clubs, both here in Australia and overseas.

Nadira will bring a wealth of knowledge to the Wellington Club.

As her final act as incumbent president, Beth then inducted Shaun Leggett as this coming year's 2026-27 President.

Shaun then introduced his Board consisting of Immediate Past President: Beth Hattenfels; Secretary: Beth Hattenfels; Treasurer: Ray Pulbrook; Service Projects Chair: Greg Wykes; Public Relations chair: Ian Parkes; Youth Service Chair: Alicia Rodriguez-Leggett who will also chair the Club Youth Protection committee.



Wellington Rotary Club's boardmembers for the next 12 months announced on Saturday evening at Wellington Golf Club: Ian Parkes, Beth Hattenfels, Greg Wykes, Ray Pulbrook, Alicia Rodriguez-Leggett and incoming president Shaun Leggett. ...More of Jo Ivey's photos on Page 5

Geurie community demands action on Scabbing Flat Bridge

GEURIE Action Group proposes a community-led solution to bypass 933-day bureaucratic bottleneck crippling Central West freight corridor.

This is in response to the Scabbing Flat Bridge Action Group's (SFBAG) call for the release of a critical report seeking an urgent meeting with Transport for NSW (TfNSW) to fast-track a new, unrestricted concrete bridge which allows BDoubles to travel from Parkes through to Dunedoo and further north of the state.

The move comes after the community was notified that the TfNSW highly anticipated report (which was endorsed by TfNSW in December 2025 and due to be released in June 2026), has been delayed.

SFBAG president, Michelle Tomkins said

the report was crucial as it represented the formal "fork in the road" for the 116-year-old timber structure determining whether the government would commit to costly permanent conservation or finally initiate planning for a dual-lane concrete replacement.

A 16-tonne weight limit was originally placed on Scabbing Flat Bridge on Friday, 1 December 2023, following an inspection that found termite damage and structural deterioration.

As of Sunday, 21 June 2026, it has been 933 days since that initial restriction was implemented.

"Local primary producers, transport operators, and residents have endured 933 days of weight restrictions and ongoing

closures since 1 December 2023," Ms Tomkins said.

A critical freight corridor is crippled

Scabbing Flat Bridge is a vital regional transport link, connecting agricultural and commercial freight moving between Parkes and the Golden Highway near Dunedoo.

"Under the Timber Truss Bridges Conservation Strategy (TTBCS), seven similar bridges were removed from the heritage retention list in 2018/19 because they could not be structurally modified to meet 'Higher Mass Limits' or wide-load regional agricultural demands without destroying their heritage fabric," Ms Tomkins said.

"The Geurie community strongly maintains that their bridge fits the exact same criteria.

"While current 2024-2026 physical works

are classified as "essential safety maintenance" to keep the bridge operating at 42.5 tonnes, the structure faces steep, ongoing maintenance deficits that continue to trigger disruptive closures.

"This is forcing modern transport and B-doubles into constant detours via Dubbo and Wellington which is economically unsustainable for the NSW regional economy."

Seeking grant funding for pre-design reports

Rather than waiting indefinitely for a stalled administrative review, the Association is prepared to independently secure grant funding to commission the essential pre-design stage reports required to advance a new bridge.

...Continued on Page 4

Inside
this
week

Local schools bring us their latest news
- Pages 13, 14, 15

Not much Budget joy for our region

THIS COLUMN was written prior to the NSW State Budget being delivered on Tuesday 23 June at 12.30pm.

However, given previous budgets, I doubt that there will be much joy for our local region.

I hope I am proved to be very wrong with that prediction. I'm basing my prediction on previous budgets that have been big on provision of essential workers (teachers, nurses, ambulance officers etc) but pretty light-on with infrastructure spending.

North Yeoval moving to Cabonne Shire

North Yeoval, 42 properties covering 170 hectares of land north of Buckinbah Creek, will very soon officially be transferred from Dubbo Regional Council to Cabonne Shire Council.

This has been Proclaimed and will soon be Gazetted, allowing an anomaly to be tidied up.

Dubbo Regional Council currently pays Cabonne Shire to undertake many of the garbage collection and mowing activities in North Yeoval whilst their crews are under-

taking the same work in Yeoval.

Water main replacement – Gisborne Street

In another necessary job that isn't cheap, Council will undertake water main replacement works along Gisborne Street, between Thornton and Pierce Streets over the coming weeks.

Works are expected to be completed by Saturday 1 August 2026, weather permitting.

Residents are advised local traffic will be affected during these works with a traffic management plan in place.

Further information about Council's water main replacement projects can be found at www.YourSay.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/dubbo-region-water-main-replacement

Shorthorn National Show and Sale

Once again Dubbo Showground played host to the Shorthorn National Show and Sale.

It was great to see some local studs winning ribbons and selling bulls, with Jim White of Suntop Shorthorns, and Nic Job of Royalla Shorthorns (Lincoln Job made the trek from

Marellan Stud at Emerald, Qld) having a successful time of it.

This was the first of four premier national cattle events in the upcoming months, showcasing some of the top studs across the country. Tuesday 30 June will see the 65th Annual Dubbo Poll Hereford National Show and Sale.

In July the 2026 National Limousin Junior Show will be held between 9 to 12 July and the 20026 National Shorthorn Youth Expo will then be held between 2 to 4 October 2026.

These events are significant within the broader cattle industry and providing the opportunity for local studs and buyers to secure top-tier genetics.

Fire pits and chimney smoke

Winter has (nearly) arrived and residents are starting to use wood heaters or recreational fire pits.

This can lead to significant amounts of smoke being in the air in built-up areas, which can exacerbate asthma and breathing problems in some members of the community.

Some tips to be a good neighbour and help keep air quality cleaner include:

- * Use dry, untreated wood in your wood heater or fire pit.
- * Get your chimney cleaned each winter.
- * Don't let a fire smoulder overnight.
- * When using a wood heater ensure the air flue is open.

If you have green waste, please use your green-lid bin to dispose of it, do not burn it.

Smoke from wood heaters and recreational fire pits can cause breathing difficulties for vulnerable residents especially people prone to respiratory conditions such as asthma.

Enjoy your recreational fire pit or wood heaters responsibly and minimise smoke to ensure everyone can breathe a little easier this winter.

Claim your tip voucher by 30 June

Council provides residents with one free visit to a Council waste facility under the Tipping Voucher scheme.

Vouchers for this financial year expire on Tuesday 30 June for residents who have not yet redeemed theirs.

Josh Black

The price of a “Leader” is only half the cost of a coffee

Death Notice

Peter Douglas Trounce

6 February, 1950 – 10 June, 2026
Aged 76

He will be forever missed and loved by all who knew him.

Peter is survived by his wife Elizabeth, sons Joshua, Samuel (dec) and Jakob, grandson Eugene. His brother John and sister Sue.

Funeral Notice

Gavon Harold Dickson

Late of Wellington
Passed away on 19th June 2026.
Aged 90 years

Beloved husband of Lola (dec)
Loved father of Margaret, Keith, Veronica and their extended families.
Cherished grandfather and great grandfather of all his grandchildren.

Relatives and friends are warmly invited to attend Gavon's funeral service to be held Graveside in Narromine Cemetery, on Monday 29th June 2026, commencing at 11am.

Funeral Notice

Brian Herbert HYDE

Aged 78 years
Late of Wellington

Much loved husband of Shirley.
Friend to many.

Relatives and friends are warmly invited to attend Brian's funeral service, to be held at St Patrick's Catholic Church Wellington on Friday 3rd July, 2026 commencing at 11am, followed by internment at Wellington Lawn Cemetery.

H Logue & Sons Funerals, Wellington NSW
02 6845 1946

Obituaries of our loved ones are welcomed for publication in the “Leader”
Contact:

mark@wdleader.news

Scan our QR code for a preview to our new website

Wellington & District LEADER



Wellington & District LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O'Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Eucharœna to Elong Elong and Yeoval within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

Wellington & District Leader is independently published locally by Mark Griggs and Sharon Wilson trading as Wellington District Leader, 14 Nancarrow Lane, Wellington, NSW, 2820, ABN: 26847723165 and printed by Gilgandra Newspapers, another independent and both members of CPNSW.

Editor: Mark Griggs
0456 940 999
email: mark@wdleader.news

Advertising Manager
Sharon Wilson
0407 935 998
email: sharon@wdleader.news

Community input and feedback is welcomed. Story leads, prepared articles and photographs can be forwarded to the publisher.

NOTICE TO ADVERTISERS, LETTER WRITERS AND READERS
The publisher accepts no responsibility for any advertisement, notice, letter or opinion published in this newspaper. Any advertisement, notice, letter or opinion published is published at the risk of the contributor who accepts liability for any intended publication. All such contributors by forwarding advertisements, notices, letters or opinions agree to indemnify the material is accurate and is neither deceptive or misleading, in breach of copyright, defamatory or in breach of any other laws and regulations.
In lodging an advertisement with us you agree that we may publish the advertisement on our website. The general terms and conditions that apply to publication of advertisements in our publication apply also to publication of material on our website. Advertising conditions of the Wellington & District Leader are available on request by phoning 0407 935 998.

Shop and buy local and the money stays in town

Choosing to spend in a Wellington business means more of that money stays in the town.

Dubbo Regional Council is using its latest campaign to remind residents that choosing local businesses over bigger centres helps keep more jobs, services and money in the community.

Looking at the power behind your spend, the campaign highlights the amount of money that stays within a community depending on where you choose to spend it.

For every \$100 spent online, only around \$4.30 stays in the local community, compared with approximately \$71.25 when you spend \$100 with a local business.

Beyond the dollars, supporting local also means backing the people, families and stories behind each business, strengthening the fabric of the community.

Alice from Alice Mary Designs said when people shop local with me I feel they are doing it in support of my business.

“To me it feels like they want me to succeed and grow.

They want to be proud of their town and what it offers.

“It means I can offer more and they don’t have to travel or search the internet and miss out of the tangible benefits of touch and feel,” she said.

Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club’s General Manager Stephen Hodges said clubs existed in the community because of the support of locals choosing local.

“Supporting local is about more than spending money; it’s about investing in the future of our community,” he said.



Shop local supporter, Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club.

“Through that support, we’re able to give back, helping local organisations, businesses and families grow together, building a strong and sustainable future for Wellington.”



Alice Mary Designs is a popular local business.

The campaign is running in local media including the *Wellington & District Leader*, and Council’s social media channels during June and July.

Update to measuring all unpaid care in the national Labour Account

IN 2024, the Australian Bureau of Statistics (ABS) was funded to expand the Labour Account to provide estimates of the total hours spent on unpaid care and their monetary value.

These measures improve the visibility of the contribution of unpaid care to society and the economy.

* Unpaid support goes beyond childcare

Unpaid care activities include not only childcare, but also the physical care of adults, travel, food preparation, shopping, general housework, household management, volunteer work and childcare.

What a workload!

* Carers create invisible income

The total value of unpaid care was \$461.1 billion in the September quarter 2025 when using the individual replacement cost method. In comparison, the minimum wage rate method was valued at \$306 billion in the September quarter 2025.

*** We’re spending more time providing a helping hand** We spent 12.3 billion hours on unpaid care activities in the September quarter 2025.

This has been a steady increase since 2006, when

people devoted 8.2 billion hours to unpaid care.

* We’re looking after our community

There were 834.2 million hours spent on volunteering activities in the September quarter 2025, valued at \$44.3 billion using the individual function replacement cost method.

Volunteering activities can include helping your neighbour or contributing through formal organisations such as your local fire brigade or hospital.

* Unpaid care is a tough balancing act

Carers who were also employed in paid work

accounted for 66 per cent of all unpaid care hours in the September quarter 2025.

By comparison, 4pc of unpaid care hours were taken on by unemployed carers, while 30pc were taken on by carers not in the labour force.

Bonus Fact

* Australian households are working hard

Couple family households represented the most unpaid care hours in the September quarter 2025, having undertaken 75pc of total hours spent.

This was higher than one parent households (12pc) and other households (13pc).



SHOP LOCAL GROW LOCAL

When you shop local,
more stays local

Every dollar you spend in Wellington supports local businesses and services that directly give back to our community.

From junior sports to arts programs, to community events and fundraisers. When you shop local, everyone benefits.

Shop Local. Grow Local.

“When you shop and support local you are supporting a family and their dream not just the bottom line”

“It’s a compound effect - when you spend and support locally it builds confidence for more businesses to back our town”

SAVVI the Label, Wellington

DUBBO REGION
CONNECT



Geurie demands action on Scabbing Flat Bridge

...From Front Page.

Ms Tomkins said the Association aimed to engage qualified consultants to undertake an economic productivity report to quantify the impact of the aging infrastructure.

“It is difficult to quantify the exact financial toll the old bridge is extracting from agricultural communities along the Parkes-to-Dunedoo freight corridor,” she said.

“Our transport and freight colleagues are deeply frustrated by the lack of progress.

“When the freight industry says enough is enough, it’s time for government to act.”

Urgent call for Action

“The Association, alongside thousands of farmers, graziers, and transport operators in the Geurie district, broader Central West in the Parkes-to-Dunedoo freight corridor, are quite frankly over it.

“We pushed TfNSW for a commitment to a new bridge back in early 2025.

“In December 2025, TfNSW

promised a comprehensive review and report in the bridge by June 2026.

“Given the massive community uproar, we took that timeline as a sign that the message had finally gotten through, that is it’s time for a modern, B-double rated bridge.

“Instead, the June report has been delayed. We followed up in mid-May and got nothing.

“We wrote to them again on the 11th of June 2026, simply seeking an update so we can report back to our members and the public at this Thursday’s AGM. Silence.

“Thankfully, we aren’t fighting alone. We greatly acknowledge the continued support of Mayor Josh Black and Dubbo Regional Council. They understand the critical importance of the primary production sector to our region, and they are genuinely dedicated to attracting the funding needed for a B-double rated bridge for Geurie.”

Ms Tomkins said the community was ready to do the heavy lifting to eliminate this regional bottleneck.

“They just need TfNSW to step up to the table and collaborate.”



Wellington Rotary Club’s newest member Nadira Tidwell was inducted by president Beth Hattenfels during the board changeover dinner on Saturday evening at Wellington Golf Club.

Calling for more doctors for the bush

LAST WEEK we welcomed Assistant Minister for International Education, Julian Hill, to Charles Sturt University (CSU) at Orange.

On the agenda was how to make regional universities viable.

CSU is burning through its cash reserves. This is not sustainable. Unless the government acts, we will lose them.

If the government wants to slash and cap their student numbers, it needs to help them stay afloat.

We also spoke about the need for more medical student places for CSU’s medical school.

There is a rural doctor shortage crisis and training doctors in the bush for practise in the bush helps get more into country areas.

Fighting for our Central West veterans

I took a question directly to the Minister for Veterans’ Affairs in Question Time earlier this week, demanding to know when the Government will support and fund a Veterans’ and Families’ Centre in Bathurst.

It would be stage one of a Central West Veterans’ and Families Hub.

While the Minister didn’t give us a definite “no”- he did acknowledge our business case and noted that the Government would look at future rounds of submissions after setting up its new agency in July.

The Bathurst RSL Sub-Branch has the land, the building, and is ready to co-invest.

This is an innovative, vital project for our region’s veterans and their families.

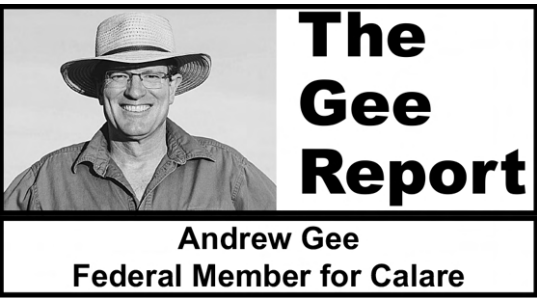
Our veterans have put their lives on the line for us, and I will keep up the fight to make sure they get the ongoing local support they deserve.

The Parliament will be hearing a lot more from me on this issue until it’s funded.

My first speech competition

The My First Speech Competition is an exciting opportunity for young people in our school communities.

This is a national competition that welcomes students in Years 10, 11 and 12 to envision themselves as newly elected Members of the House of Representatives and write a three-minute speech,



focusing on a topic they’re passionate about.

One winner from each year group will present their speech to the Speaker and members live at Parliament House, receiving an expenses-paid trip to Parliament House in Canberra, including flights and accommodation, and a prize pack valued at \$250.

As your Federal Member I highly encourage students in Years 10, 11 and 12 to get involved!

This is a great competition to develop as our future local leaders – learning about the work of the Australian Parliament and gaining experience in writing and public speaking.

For further information and entry submission, please visit the website: <https://mfs.houseofrepresentatives.gov.au/>

Entries to the My First Speech Competition close on 11.59pm AEST on Monday 20 July 2026.

Good luck!

Australia Post grant

Applications are now open for the 2026 Australia Post Community Grants Program, offering grants of up to \$10,000 for community-led projects that help people connect and improve mental health and wellbeing in local communities.

An additional \$250,000 is available for projects supporting communities recovering from natural disasters or major storm events.

Eligible not-for-profit organisations are encouraged to apply.

Applications close: 6 July 2026 (11.59pm AEST).

For guidelines and eligibility information, visit <https://auspost.com.au/about-us/supporting-communities>

Did you know 82% of people say

PRINT ADS are STILL the most trusted

form of advertising for making purchasing decisions



with Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld

WHEN THOMAS Edison developed his long-lasting carbon-filament light bulb in 1879, it changed the world.

For more than a century afterwards, we accepted that producing light required a certain amount of electricity.

The bulbs improved over time, but the basic principle remained largely unchanged.

In 2010 I made the very expensive decision to replace every light in one of my businesses with LED lighting.

At the time, the upfront cost was significant, but the lower electricity bills meant the investment would pay for itself within about 18 months.

Today, it is difficult to find many new light fittings that are not LED. The technology succeeded because it delivered the same result while using far less energy.

The interesting thing about technological progress is that it often begins when somebody questions an assumption everyone else has accepted.

Which brings me to coffee.

Millions of people start their day with a cup

of coffee without giving much thought to the electricity involved.

We simply accept that making espresso requires hot water, pressure and beans.

Much like the old light bulb, it is a process that has become so familiar that few people stop to ask whether there might be a better way. Researchers at the University of New South Wales have done exactly that.

Their solution sounds more like something from a science fiction novel than a café menu. Instead of using near-boiling water, they have developed a method of brewing espresso using ultrasonic soundwaves.

The result is a coffee-making process that uses around 75 per cent less energy while producing a drink that coffee lovers struggle to distinguish from a traditional espresso.

I suspect recruiting volunteers for the taste-testing phase was probably the easiest part of the project.

Traditional espresso relies on heat and pressure to extract flavour, oils and caffeine from coffee grounds. The UNSW team discovered they could achieve a similar result using

ultrasonic vibrations in room-temperature water. These soundwaves create microscopic bubbles that rapidly form and collapse in a process known as acoustic cavitation.

As they burst, they help release the flavours from the coffee grounds.

Think of it as millions of microscopic brushes working their way through the coffee. The researchers spent considerable time refining the process. The water-to-coffee ratio, grind size and exposure time all had to be carefully adjusted to create a concentrated espresso rather than a diluted brew. Once they believed they had perfected the technique, they conducted blind taste tests involving 100 coffee drinkers.

Participants sampled traditional espresso and filter coffee alongside the ultrasonic versions.

The results were remarkable. Most people could not consistently tell the difference between the conventional and ultrasonic brews. But this story is not really about coffee. It is about a growing trend in innovation.

For decades, progress was often measured

by making things bigger, faster or more powerful.

Increasingly, the next generation of breakthroughs is focused on efficiency.

How can we achieve the same outcome while consuming much less energy?

We have already seen this with lighting. We are seeing it with electric vehicles, smart buildings and modern appliances.

Across almost every industry, engineers are finding ways to deliver the same result with less energy. Coffee may simply be the latest example. If ultrasonic brewing can be scaled commercially, the implications extend well beyond home kitchens.

Cafés, offices, airports and beverage manufacturers collectively consume enormous amounts of energy every day.

Even relatively small savings can become significant when multiplied across millions of cups.

And if the future can save energy without compromising the taste of a good coffee, that sounds like a technology Australians can happily embrace.

Snapped at Rotary Club's Changeover dinner



Rotary Club president Beth Hattenfels presents a new members pack to Prof Nadira Tidwell with Jennifer Wykes.



Outgoing president Beth Hattenfels congratulates incoming president Shaun Leggett.



Janelle Leggett received the Rising Rotarian award.



Beth Hattenfels presented the Paul Harris Award to Ray Pulbrook.



Greg Wykes received the Helping Hand award.



ABOVE: Greg Hart received the Heart of Service award.



Richard Eade was presented the "Keeper of Traditions" award.



LEFT: Robert Toynnton with his "Steadfast" award.



Alan and Bev Hutchinson attended the Rotary Changeover dinner.



Wayne Hattenfels received the 'Fellowship and Mischief' award.



Results from Fashions Mount Rifle Club meet on Saturday, June 20.

Hunting Class at 200 Yards: S. King 96.8, L. Hough 94.6, R. Dowton 90.2, B. Spedding 84.1, D. Gollan 79.

Next Shoot Saturday, July 4 at 800 yards.
The Rifleman

Restorative Yoga
first and third Sunday of month
Seniors Tai Chi every Friday 9:30am
Open Sundays 1pm-4pm
Empathetic Counselling
by Appointment 6845 4661
 **Wellington Buddhist Centre**
Tharpa Choeling Australia

**WELLINGTON MEN'S SHED**
Join us for friendship or fabrication or both
NEW MEMBERS WELCOME
SHED OPEN
Monday, Wednesday & Friday
from 8:30 – 12:00pm
Give us a call on 6845 2070


Styled by Sim
**Simone McManus**
Suite 1
36-42 Swift St
Wellington
02 6845 1976

**Wellington Baptist Church**
ALL WELCOME
Join us for Sunday Service
Sunday 9:30am, Pastor Rudolph Kock
Mobile 0475799036

**keirle's pharmacy**  **alliance PHARMACY**
where local health matters



Ask our team for
Winter Wellness
generic
alternatives
- same active
ingredients
- less \$\$\$

31 Nanima Crescent, Wellington
02 6845 2059
email:keirles@alliancepharmacy.com.au * Check us out on facebook

For Sale

TRAYMOUNT SPRAYER
500 LITRES
Bertolini Italian pump - retractable hose 100m
Honda motor -turbo spray gun
done little work new price \$13,737.50
asking \$8000.00 phone 0428 635 994

Return Thanks

The family of the late **Leon Gough** wish to express their heartfelt thanks to the many people who have shared messages, cards and thoughts of Leon who passed on 6 May, 2026. Your support received during this time has been sincerely appreciated. Please accept this as our personal thanks.
The Gough Family.

Water Delivery

Domestic Water Deliveries
Servicing Wellington Region
Fiona: 0427 463 441 Ken: 0427 463 442

We'll fit any size

Phone
0407 935 998

Tell our advertisers
you saw it in the
‘Leader’

Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington
WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church
Sunday 9am
Sunday 5pm - The Gathering
MARANATHA
11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church
77 Swift Street
9:30am Sunday mornings
6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church
Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick’s Catholic Parish

Saturday
5pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington
8.30am - Stuart Town

Sunday
8am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
10am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month
10am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
8am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month

Weekday mass
Please check parish bulletin

In Christ Chapel
2pm Sunday

Everyone looks at the classifieds.

Promote your

Annual General Meetings

Social Club Events,

Birthday Parties

Homes and Flats to rent or wanted to rent

Lost and Found

Garage Sale

Memorium

Public Notice

Raffle prize winners

NSW Budget falls short for farmers

NSW FARMERS has expressed deep concern the 2026-27 NSW State Budget has failed to deliver the transformational investment the agricultural sector needs, as the State’s farmers push toward a \$30 billion industry by 2030 – a goal the Government says it enthusiastically supports.

NSW Farmers President Xavier Martin said existing commitments for feral pig controls, the State’s Cattle Tick Program, regional roads and the AgSkilled program had been previously announced and the Budget failed to address the sector’s overarching concerns.

“Producers are facing generational challenges and what we’ve seen today is a recycled response that does nothing to address the issues that matter most,” Mr Martin said.

“Agriculture is an economic powerhouse, contributing more than \$25 billion to the NSW economy and supporting tens of thousands of jobs in our regions.

“We put a comprehensive, fully costed roadmap, to achieve a \$30 billion sector, on the table including investments in R&D, land tax reform, biosecurity, rail, water, land use and our workforce - every one of them with a positive

return for the NSW taxpayer.

“The Premier has previously said that as the State transitions away from coal towards primary industries there will be no strong NSW without a strong agriculture sector.

“We agree, but a budget that fails to back that roadmap is a budget that fails to achieve this ambition.”

Mr Martin said that while NSW Farmers acknowledged the Government’s fiscal challenges, the sector’s needs could not be deferred indefinitely.

“NSW farmers are dealing with cost-of-production shocks, natural disasters, failing local roads, a biosecurity system under siege and a rising tax burden - all at the same time,” Mr Martin said.

“This is the last budget before polling day - and on today’s showing, there is a great deal of unfinished business.

“We will now be seeking binding, funded commitments from all parties ahead of the next NSW election - and we will be letting our members know exactly who has stood up for them, and who has not.”

Around the electorate

with our State Member Dugald Saunders

Blink and you’ll miss it

THE MINNS Labor Government released its 2026/27 Budget on Tuesday and to say it missed the mark is an understatement.

It was a real ‘blink and you’ll miss it’ kind of Budget for the Dubbo electorate, except there wasn’t actually anything to miss.

As expected, there was funding allocated to continue projects that are already underway, including the Orana Heights Public School Upgrade, the final stages of the Dubbo Bridge and the Serengeti Experience out at Taronga Western Plains Zoo.

But in terms of any new infrastructure and spending, there was zilch.

Not even a line item for the already announced \$15.3 million for PCYC Sports World as a consolation for the Dubbo Sports Hub project Labor so callously axed.

The Coalition will deliver its Budget in Reply on Thursday. Watch this space.

Nurse Practitioners

Last Friday I had the privilege of attending the Australian College of Nurse Practitioners Rural Symposium held out at Taronga Western Plains Zoo.

6 THURSDAY, JUNE 25, 2026, WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

This two-day event had Nurse Practitioners from across our region come together to share experiences with a specific focus on rural practice. Nurse Practitioners are vital to the wellbeing of our communities, particularly in regional and remote NSW.

Educated at a Master’s level or higher, Nurse Practitioners have a scope of practice that extends far beyond what many people traditionally associate with nursing.

In many settings, Nurse Practitioners work as autonomous clinicians and fill the gaps in communities without adequate access to care to ensure they do not go without.

But this specialty is not without its challenges.

At the symposium I heard about the barriers our Nurse Practitioners currently face, including restricted access to Medicare Benefits, complex prescribing arrangements for the PBS and the inability to sign off on applications for the Isolated Patients Travel and Accommodation Assistance Scheme and death certificates.

Our Nurse Practitioners are calling for an urgent review of telehealth rules for rural and remote areas, and they want access to Bulk

Billing under Medicare, extended access to Medicare Benefits for diagnostics, procedures and referrals, and the ability to prescribe subsidised medicines for our veterans.

If we’re serious about improving health outcomes in regional and remote NSW, then we must be equally serious about supporting Nurse Practitioners.

We just need to make sure these highly skilled professionals have the tools, support and recognition they deserve.

Shorthorn Show & Sale

It was a big few days at the Dubbo Showground with the 67th National Shorthorn Show & Sale last week.

This multi-vendor sale is a premier event, and this year featured 111 Led Bulls and 9 Special Females across 11 Classes.

Events like this are significant not just for the cattle industry but also our region, as visitors from across the country bring a massive economic boost to our local businesses.

Next up Dubbo will host the 65th Annual Dubbo Poll Hereford National Show and Sale on 30 June, followed by the National

Limousin Junior Show in July and the 2026 National Shorthorn Youth Expo in October.

Well done to the National Shorthorn Show & Sale committee, members, vendors and sponsors on another fantastic event!

Rego Rebate

An elected NSW Nationals and Liberals Government will deliver a \$100 registration rebate for the state’s drivers as part of a broader plan to ease the cost of living.

Under our plan, motorists to claim the \$100 rebate on the 2027 registration of a private-use vehicle, with drivers eligible to a rebate on up to two private vehicles.

The registration rebate is practical cost of living relief and combined with the restoration of the Regional Seniors Travel Card, shows the NSW Coalition has a clear plan to support families and ease pressure on household budgets.

We’re not the only ones who think this rebate is worthwhile, because in a surprising little ‘copy-paste’ moment, on Tuesday we saw the Minns Labor Government announce the same rebate included in their 2026/27 Budget.

Until next time, Dugald.

Letter to the editor

Editor,
AS WE temporarily attempt survival with rebates, handouts and wealth redistribution it appears that at least some are realising that the “long game” needs more consideration.

With National Debt now in the Trillion Dollar arena a colleague said to me this week that “Elon Musk as the first Trillionsire could spend \$1 million/day for 2700 years” and if true and you relate this to the Trillion-dollar Australian National debt we are passing to future taxpayers we have to take a hard look at what we are demanding and doing in our present lives.

In our own community we have seen the local council, once administered by a Council Clerk on wages, under the direction of an unpaid Shire President, appointed by elected Aldermen become a “multi-million dollar Corporation” run by a CEO or General Manager and numerous Directors on multi-thousand dollar salaries with staffing levels out of all proportion to the services they provide and structured to comply more with regulations than ratepayer requirements.

Every day there are demands by Councils throughout NSW requesting rate increases above their cap to continue providing the services they were originally created to provide.

When the present Federal Government was first elected we read where the Prime Minister immediately increased his advisory staff by 26 and 44000 new Public Servants were employed in Canberra and current statistics reveal that one in every four new jobs created in Australia are Taxpayer funded.

In an era where housing is such a “hot topic” we

have seen the highest level of builders ever going into liquidation and Development approvals have become a costly and delaying nightmare.

We in Wellington can be thankful that we still have a number of good building tradesmen with multiple skills and diverse income means despite an exodus to taxpayer funded employment.

In so many places, especially Wellington we once had “big business”, with significant Chinese and Greek ownership, and Government Intrusion was there but minimal and Business Profit was invariably contributed to Community Development.

After a week or so on the Gold Coast and in Sydney the benefits of “Contributory Migration” were very obvious, as it is here in Wellington at Maranatha House and is welcome to see support for these types of contributors.

As a final point, the large number of Staff Vehicles parked at our schools creates questions about what roles and responsibility all these staff have other than teaching?

With less home parenting, Day Care and PreSchool and so many behavioural and mental issues I guess Schools have become multifunctional around actual teaching.

In relation to this, it has to be alarming that today over three-million Australians are on prescribed Mental Medication and over 700,000 of these are diagnosed with ADHD and I guess this infiltrates into schools increasing the teacher support and taxpayer burden.

We can’t go back but we must change for the sake of future generations.

Roger Everett

Farmers express reservations at paraquat restrictions

NSW FARMERS has expressed reservations at the Australian Pesticides and Veterinary Medicines Authority’s (APVMA) decision to impose onerous restrictions on paraquat and diquat, warning the outcome will have significant on-ground impacts for farmers.

NSW Farmers President Xavier Martin said farmers respect the role of the APVMA as Australia’s independent, science-based regulator, but the decision raises serious and practical concerns for agricultural productivity, stewardship of the landscape and biosecurity.

“Farmers respect science - but we also need decisions that work in the paddock,” Mr Martin said.

“Right now, there’s a real risk we’re being left without a tool we rely on, and without an equal replacement,”

“It is encouraging to see that some of the practical issues raised by farmers have been taken into account in the final decision, particularly the recognition of optical spraying systems and the higher rates for those targeted technologies.

“This shows that when farmers engage constructively and put forward evidence, regulators are prepared to listen - but the reality is that the final decision still falls short of what’s needed on farm.”

The ongoing concern is that the broadacre application rate remains too low to be effective in many real-world farming situations.

“Reducing application rates to the point where these products are potentially no longer effective doesn’t remove any perceived risk - it removes a critical solution.”

Paraquat and diquat are key tools for managing weeds particularly where herbicide resistance is already a significant challenge and alternative chemistry is limited or unavailable.

“Farmers are deeply committed to managing their land responsibly, including minimising chemical use and protecting soil health,” Mr Martin said.

“But you can’t effectively remove or downgrade a vital tool like this without a viable alternative ready and expect there to be no consequences.”

NSW Farmers welcomed the two-year phase-out period, noting it provides some time for adjustment, but warned it does not reduce the challenge facing farmers.

“A transition period is important, but it doesn’t solve the underlying problem,” Mr Martin said.

“What farmers need now is not just regulatory change, but practical solutions - including investment in alternative chemistry and a clear pathway that reflects the realities of Australian agriculture.”

NSW Farmers emphasised that human health and safety remain paramount, and that farmers already operate under strict regulatory frameworks governing chemical use.

“Our members take chemical stewardship extremely seriously.

“They undergo training, operate within tight regulations, and want access to tools that are both safe and effective,” Mr Martin said.

NSW Farmers will be actively calling on government to support farmers and undertake further research around this decision and its practical implementation on the ground.

*Share your copy of this paper,
let everyone have a good read*



Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL MEMBER FOR CALARE

Runs on the Board for the Wellington Area

- ✓ \$9.5 million to build a new, purposebuilt wing focused on dementia and palliative care at Maranatha House
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$1.1 million for Ponto Falls Road upgrade
- ✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project
- ✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges
- ✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge
- ✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park
- ✓ Video link for Wellington Court House

- ✓ \$26,700 for the Driver Reviver site at the Wellington Information Centre
- ✓ \$1.176 million for improvements at Wellington Caves
- ✓ \$1.5 million for the intergenerational childcare facility at Maranatha House
- ✓ \$1.2 million for security CCTV in Wellington and Calare communities
- ✓ \$50,000 for Wellington Library’s outdoor reading room



✓ \$12 million in disaster funding for the Duke of Wellington Bridge

6.00 Morning Programs. **11.20** Dr Karl's How Things Work. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** The Capture. **2.00** Spicks And Specks. **2.30** Anh's Brush With Fame. **3.00** Restoration Australia. **4.00** Frankie Drake Mysteries. **4.45** Long Lost Family. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Restoration Australia. **9.00** Ground Up. **9.30** Twenty Twenty Six. **10.00** Ross Harris: Primitime Predator. Final. **10.55** ABC Late News. **11.10** The Business. **11.25** Frankie Drake Mysteries. **12.10** Late Programs.

6.00 News Breakfast. **9.00** ABC News Mornings. **10.00** Compass. **10.30** Stuff The British Stole. **11.00** Race Around The World. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** The Assembly. **1.45** Ground Up. **2.15** Guy Montgomery's Guy Mont Spelling Bee. **3.00** Restoration Australia. **4.00** Murdoch Mysteries. **4.45** Long Lost Family. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** Monty Don's British Gardens. New. **8.30** Shetland. **9.30** Twenty Twenty Six. **10.30** Gruen. **11.05** ABC Late News. **11.25** Guy Montgomery's Guy Mont Spelling Bee. **12.10** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** Imagine Holidays Iconic Rail Journeys. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** RSPCA Animal Rescue. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** The World's Most Scenic Railway Journeys. **8.30** Escape To The Country. **10.30** Horse Racing. Royal Ascot. **3.30** Late Programs.

1.05pm Beyond Paradise. **2.00** ER. **2.45** Abbott Elementary. **3.05** QI. **3.35** Would I Lie To You? **4.05** MythBusters. **4.55** Phil Spencer: Secret Agent Specials. **5.45** Grand Designs NZ. **6.30** House Of Games. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** **MOVIE:** Game Night. (2018) **10.10** Late Programs.

6.00 Rage Charts. **7.00** Weekend Breakfast. **9.00** Rage. **10.30** Rage Vault Guest Programmer. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **12.30** Death In Paradise. **1.30** Shetland. **2.30** Shanghai Symphony Orchestra. **4.25** Stuff The British Stole. **5.00** Australian Story. **5.30** Landline. **6.00** Kath & Kim. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** Death In Paradise. Final. **8.30** The Hardacres. **10.05** The Capture. **11.05** Rage.

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.30** Harry's Practice. **2.00** Better Homes And Gardens. **3.00** Secrets Of Beautiful Gardens. **4.00** Escape To The Country. **5.00** Dog Patrol. **5.30** The World's Most Scenic Railway Journeys. **6.30** Bondi Vet. **7.30** The Yorkshire Vet. **8.30** Lewis. **10.30** Horse Racing. Royal Ascot. **3.30** Late Programs.

2.20pm ER. **3.05** A Bite To Eat. **3.35** QI. **4.05** Would I Lie To You? **4.35** MythBusters. **5.25** Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. **6.15** Grand Designs NZ. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Guy Montgomery's Guy Mont Spelling Bee. **9.20** Live At The Apollo. **10.05** Late Programs.

6.00 Rage. **7.00** Weekend Breakfast. **9.00** Insiders. **10.00** Offsiders. **10.30** The World This Week. **11.00** Compass. **11.30** Songs Of Praise. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **12.30** Landline. **1.30** Monty Don's British Gardens. **2.30** Race Around The World. **3.30** Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. **4.00** Restoration Australia. **5.00** Back Roads. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Compass. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** Race Around The World. **8.30** Ground Up. **9.05** The Capture. **10.00** Death In Paradise. Final. **11.00** The Hardacres. **12.30** Rage. **3.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.30** Your Money & Your Life. **1.00** Better Homes And Gardens. **2.00** South Aussie With Cosi. **2.30** The Surgery Ship. **3.30** The Yorkshire Vet. **4.30** My Greek Odyssey. **5.30** Australia's Amazing Homes. **6.30** Escape To The Country. **7.30** The Coroner. **8.30** Vera. **10.30** Malpractice. **11.30** Late Programs.

1.50pm ER. **2.35** My Family. **3.05** A Bite To Eat. **3.35** QI. **4.05** Would I Lie To You? **4.35** MythBusters. **5.25** Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. **6.15** Grand Designs NZ. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Amazing Spaces. **9.20** Race Around The World. **10.20** Late Programs.

6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** Seven's National News At Noon. **1.00** Beat The Chasers UK. **2.00** Bridge Of Lies. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6:30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** Highway Patrol Special. **8.30** **Air Crash Investigations.** **9.30** **Homicide: With Ron Iddles.** **10.30** Police Code Zero: Officer Under Attack. **11.30** Autopsy USA. **12.30** Brave New World. **1.30** ICU. **2.00** Home Shopping. **4.00** NBC Today. **5.00** Sunrise Early News. **5.30** Sunrise.

6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** Seven's National News At Noon. **1.00** Your Money & Your Life. **1.30** Border Security: International. **2.00** Bridge Of Lies: Celebrity Specials. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6:30. **7.00** **Better Homes And Gardens.** **8.00** **MOVIE: Inferno.** (2016) **10.30** To Be Advised. **12.10** **MOVIE:** Lethal Love Letter. (2021) Clare Grant. **2.30** Home Shopping. **4.00** Million Dollar Minute. **5.00** NBC Today.

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** Timbersports. Aust C'ship Pt 2. Replay. **3.30** Mountain Men. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers: Best Of. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.00** AFL: Friday Night Countdown. **7.30** Football. AFL. Gold Coast Suns v Hawthorn. **10.30** AFL Post-Game Show. **11.15** Late Programs.

6.00 Kids' Programs. **5.30** Talking Tom Heroes. **6.05** Spidey And His Amazing Friends. **6.25** The Adventures Of Paddington. **6.45** Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago: Dragons Rising. **8.00** Young Sheldon. **8.25** Young Sheldon. **8.40** Ultimate Vets. **9.05** Animal Park. **9.50** Secrets Of The Zoo. **10.35** Late Programs.

6.00 NBC Today. **7.00** Weekend Sunrise. **10.00** The Morning Show: Weekend. **12.00** Horse Racing. Civic Stakes Day, VRC Country Race Day and Ipswich Cup. **5.00** Seven News At 5. **5.30** Border Security: Australia's Front Line. **6.00** Seven News. **7.00** Better Homes And Gardens. **8.00** Border Security: Australia's Front Line. **8.30** **MOVIE:** The Equalizer 3. (2023) Denzel Washington, Dakota Fanning, Eugenio Mastrandrea. **10.45** Motor Racing. Supercars C'ship. Darwin Triple Crown. H'lights. **11.45** Motorway Patrol. **12.15** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.30** Lady Torque TV. **2.00** Rides Down Under: Workshop Wars. **3.00** Motor Racing. National Drag Racing C'ship. Top Doorslammer. Riverbend Nationals. **4.00** Football. AFL. GWS Giants v Carlton. **7.00** Storage Wars. **7.30** **MOVIE:** Back To The Future. (1985) **10.00** **MOVIE:** Battleship. (2012) **12.40** Late Programs.

6.00 Kids' Programs. **5.10** Octonauts: Above And Beyond. **5.35** Super Monsters. **6.05** PJ Masks. **6.25** Emerald. **7.05** Let's Go Bananas! **7.30** Kids Baking Championship. **8.10** Kids BBQ Championship. **8.55** Capcr Crew. Final. **9.40** Fresh Off The Boat. **10.25** Abbott Elementary. **10.45** Late Programs.

6.00 Better Homes And Gardens. **7.00** Weekend Sunrise. **10.00** The Morning Show: Weekend. **12.00** Sunday Footy Feast. **2.30** House Of Wellness. **3.30** The Salvation Army: Red Shield Appeal. **4.00** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.00** Seven News At 5. **5.30** Sydney Weekender. **6.00** Seven News. **7.00** Farmer Wants A Wife. **8.30** 7NEWS Spotlight. **9.30** 24 Hours In Police Custody. **12.05** Motor Racing. Supercars C'ship. Darwin Triple Crown. H'lights. **1.05** Harry's Practice. **2.00** Home Shopping. **3.30** Million Dollar Minute. **4.00** NBC Today. **5.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.00** Mark Berg's Fishing Addiction. **2.00** Fishy Business. **2.30** AFL Pre-Game Show. **3.00** Football. AFL. St Kilda v Western Bulldogs. **6.00** Border Security: International. **7.00** Border Security: Australia's Front Line. **8.30** **MOVIE:** Bad Boys II. (2003) Will Smith, Martin Lawrence. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Kids' Programs. **3.00** Play School. **3.25** PJ Masks Power Heroes. **3.50** Odd Squad. **4.25** Little J And Big Cuz. **5.15** Isadora Moon. **5.40** Super Monsters. **6.05** PJ Masks. **6.25** Emerald. **7.05** Let's Go Bananas! **7.30** **MOVIE:** Fantastic Mr. Fox. (2009) **8.50** Animal Park. **10.20** Secrets Of The Zoo. **11.05** Late Programs.

6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** **MOVIE:** Finding Love In Saint Lucia. (2023) **2.00** Pointless. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Rugby League. Under-19s State Of Origin. NSW v Qld. **9.35** Under 19s State Of Origin Post-Match. **10.00** 9News Late. **10.30** Bad Blood. **11.30** Next Stop. **12.00** Tipping Point. **1.00** Fish Forever. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.30** Global Shop. **3.00** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **4.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** **MOVIE:** The Better Man. (2025) **2.00** Pointless. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Rugby League. NRL. Knights v Dragons. **9.55** NRL Friday Night Footy Post-Match. **10.45** **MOVIE:** Lethal Weapon 2. (1989) Mel Gibson, Danny Glover, Joe Pesci. **1.00** Next Stop. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **4.00** Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. **4.30** Global Shop. **5.00** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **5.30** Postcards.

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** The Great Day Out. **10.30** My Kitchen Rules. **12.00** The Good Doctor. **2.00** Extreme Weddings: Australia. **3.00** The Food Dude. **3.30** The Goldbergs. **4.00** The Connors. **5.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** Ramsay's Kitchen Nightmares USA. **10.30** First Dates UK. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.00** ABC News Day. **3.00** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** Afternoon Briefing. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.45** The Business. **9.00** The World. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.30** Stateline. **11.00** ABC Late News. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Getaway. **6.30** A Current Affair. **7.00** Weekend Today. **10.00** Today Extra: Saturday. **12.00** Surfing Australia TV. **12.30** Drive TV Presents. **1.00** Explore TV Viking. **1.30** My Way. **1.45** Space Invaders. **2.45** Shark! **4.00** Tasman Trails. **5.00** 9News First At Five. **5.30** Getaway. **6.00** 9News Saturday. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** **MOVIE:** National Treasure. (2004) Nicolas Cage, Diane Kruger. **10.10** **MOVIE:** The Tomorrow War. (2021) Chris Pratt. **12.40** Law & Order: Organized Crime. **1.35** Explore TV Viking. **2.00** The Incredible Journey Presents. **2.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** New Idea Test Kitchen. **12.30** Yummy Mummies. **1.30** 10 Years Younger In 10 Days. **2.25** Instant Hotel. **3.40** Dancing With The Stars. **5.40** **MOVIE:** Stuart Little. (1999) **7.30** **MOVIE:** Shotgun Wedding. (2022) Jennifer Lopez. **9.45** **MOVIE:** Wild Things. (1998) Kevin Bacon. **11.55** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** News. **3.30** That Pacific Sports Show. **4.00** News. **4.30** Compass. **5.00** News. **5.30** Asia News Week. **6.00** Evening News. **6.25** Aust Story. **7.00** National News. **7.30** Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. **8.10** Four Corners. **9.00** ABC Nightly News. **9.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Hello SA. **6.30** A Current Affair. **7.00** Weekend Today. **10.00** Wide World Of Sports. **11.00** NRL Sunday Footy Show. **1.00** GolfBarons. **1.30** Fish Forever. **2.00** Taronga: Who's Who In The Zoo. **3.00** Rugby League. NRL. Melbourne Storm v Canberra Raiders. **6.00** 9News Sunday. **7.00** 60 Minutes. **8.00** Boy George & Culture Club. **10.00** 9News Late. **10.30** The First 48. **11.25** Love Cheats. **12.15** Tasman Trails. **1.05** GolfBarons. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **4.00** Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. **4.30** CampByMe. **5.00** Today Early News. **5.30** Today.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.30** Home And Away. **2.30** Farmer Wants A Wife. **4.10** Unbelievable Moments Caught On Camera. **5.00** Dr Harry's Animal Encounters. **6.00** Puppy School. **6.30** Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly. **7.30** Law & Order: Criminal Intent. **8.30** Law & Order: SVU. **10.30** Bones. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** News. **3.30** Offsiders. **4.00** Landline. **5.00** ABC News With Auslan. **5.30** ABC News Regional. **6.00** ABC Evening News. **6.30** Expanse: The Nannup Four. Final. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** Insiders. **8.35** If You're Listening. **9.00** ABC Nightly News. **9.25** Australian Story. **10.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **7.30** Good Chef Bad Chef. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Entertainment Tonight. **10.20** MasterChef Australia. **11.30** Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. **12.00** Good Chef Bad Chef. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** 10 News: Lunchtime. **2.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **7.30** Taskmaster Australia. **8.40** NCIS. **9.40** 10's Late News. **10.40** The Big Bang Theory. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Entertainment Tonight. **10.20** MasterChef Australia. **11.30** Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. **12.00** Good Chef Bad Chef. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** 10 News: Lunchtime. **2.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **7.30** Selling Houses Australia. **8.30** Have You Been Paying Attention? **9.30** 10's Late News. **10.30** The Big Bang Theory. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Home Shopping. **8.00** Days Of Our Lives. **8.45** The Young And The Restless. **9.30** JAG. **11.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** Building The Dream. **2.30** Bull. **3.30** JAG. **5.30** Bull. **6.30** Building The Dream. **7.30** NCIS. **10.20** Bull. **11.15** JAG. **1.15** Home Shopping.

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.00** The Brokenwood Mysteries. **3.00** Antiques Downunder. **3.30** **MOVIE:** The Man Who Haunted Himself. (1970) **5.30** Yorkshire Auction House. **6.30** Antiques Roadshow. **7.30** Escape To The Chateau. **8.40** **MOVIE:** Casino Royale. (2006) Daniel Craig, Eva Green. **11.35** Late Programs.

6.00 Tough Tested. **7.00** Reel Action. **7.30** Escape Fishing With ET. **8.00** IFISH. **8.30** Cannonball Run Down Under. **9.00** All 4 Adventure. **10.00** Pat Callinan's 4x4 Adventures. **11.00** Intrepid Adventures. **11.30** Farm To Fork. **12.00** MasterChef Australia. **1.00** Good Food Everyday With Gary Mehigan. **1.30** Frugal Foodie. **2.00** Deal Or No Deal. **2.30** Millionaire Hot Seat. **3.00** The Finish Line. **4.00** Lingo. **5.00** 10 News. **6.30** The Dog House. **7.30** Selling Houses Australia. **9.30** Ambulance UK. **11.30** FBI. **12.30** Home Shopping. **5.00** Hour Of Power.

6.00 Home Shopping. **9.00** Reel Action. **9.30** Pat Callinan's 4x4 Adventures. **10.30** Navigating The World. **11.30** Roads Less Travelled. **12.30** Top Gear Australia. **2.00** The Living Room. **3.00** JAG. **5.00** Escape Fishing With ET. **5.30** JAG. **7.30** NCIS. **10.20** JAG. **12.15** Home Shopping.

6.00 Morning Programs. **9.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **10.00** Helping Hands. **10.30** **MOVIE:** Champagne Charlie. (1944) **12.40** **MOVIE:** The Courtneys Of Curzon Street. (1947) **3.00** Rugby Union. Shute Shield. Gordon v Eastern Suburbs. **5.00** **MOVIE:** The Amazing Howard Hughes. (1977) **7.30** To Be Advised. **12.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Mass For You At Home. **6.30** Key Of David. **7.00** Joseph Prince: New Creation Church. **7.30** Silvia's Italian Masterclass. **8.00** 10 Minute Kitchen. **8.30** My Market Kitchen. **9.00** Freshly Picked With Simon Toohey. **9.30** Luca's Key Ingredient. **10.00** The Chef's Garden. **10.40** MasterChef Australia. **1.00** Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly Australia. **2.00** Deal Or No Deal. **2.30** Millionaire Hot Seat. **3.00** The Finish Line. **4.00** Lingo. **5.00** 10 News. **6.30** 10 News+. **7.00** MasterChef Australia. **8.15** Watson. **9.15** FBI. **12.00** 10 News+. **12.30** Home Shopping.

6.00 Home Shopping. **8.00** Pooches At Play. **9.00** On The Fly. **9.30** Reel Action. **10.00** Navigating The World. **11.00** Escape Fishing With ET. **11.30** All 4 Adventure. **12.30** Tough Tested. **2.30** The Living Room. **3.30** JAG. **7.30** **MOVIE:** Forrest Gump. (1994) Tom Hanks. **10.15** Blue Bloods. **11.15** JAG. **12.15** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.30** The Baron. **1.30** Motorway Cops: Catching Britain's Speeders. **2.30** Explore. **2.45** **MOVIE:** We Of The Never Never. (1982) **5.30** Midsomer Murders. **7.30** David Attenborough's Mammals. **8.40** Paramedics. **9.40** Emergency. **10.40** Major Crimes. **11.40** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.30** Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Group I. FRA v SEN. Replay. **5.30** Letters And Numbers. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.35** Fortress Britain With Alice Roberts. **8.30** Saving Yellowstone. **9.25** A Gentleman In Moscow. **10.15** SBS World News Late. **10.45** FIFA World Cup 2026: Highlights Show. **11.15** The Boys Who Said No. **12.15** Robson Green's Weekend Escapes. **12.50** Going Places With Ernie Dingo. **1.30** Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Group A. CZE v RSA. **4.30** Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Group B. SUI v BIH.

6.00 Morning Programs. **9.00** Family Feud. **10.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **10.30** Becker. **11.00** Frasier. **12.00** Lingo. **1.00** Friends. **3.00** Frasier. **4.00** Good Chef Bad Chef. **4.30** Becker. **5.00** The Big Bang Theory. **6.00** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** The Cheap Seats. **11.00** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.30** WorldWatch. **5.30** The Secret Genius Of Modern Life. **6.40** Jeopardy! **7.35** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **8.30** Cup Fever! **9.00** Mysteries Unearthed With Danny Trejo. **9.50** The Americans. **10.45** Lee Lin Chin's Fashionista. **11.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.35** Megastructures: Knights Templar Castles. **4.35** Hitler: A Life In Pictures. **5.35** Underground Army. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Group D. USA v AUS. Replay. **9.30** Shut Your Big Fat Mouth John Safran! **10.45** FIFA World Cup 2026: Highlights Show. **11.15** Snowpiercer. **12.10** Robson Green's Weekend Escapes. **1.25** Great British Railway Journeys. **2.00** Going Places With Ernie Dingo. **2.30** Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Group F. NED v SWE. **5.30** Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Group E. GER v CIV.

6.00 Good Chef Bad Chef. **7.00** The Bold And The Beautiful. **9.30** Millionaire Hot Seat. **11.00** **Good Chef Bad Chef.** **11.30** **Ridiculousness.** **1.00** Friends. **6.00** **The Big Bang Theory.** **10.30** **Ridiculousness.** **12.00** Home Shopping.

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.40**

5x5

No. 397

Insert the missing letters to make 10 words – five reading across the grid and five reading down.

W		L		S
	W		I	
T		S		E
	R		E	
H		R		S

Edgeword

Place each of the tiles of letters into the blank jigsaw below to create four six-letter words going across and down.

AL

TU

LI

ES

PP

RI

LE

VI

There may be more than one possible answer.

No. 249

Crossmath

No. 247

Insert each number from 1 to 9 in the shaded squares to solve all the horizontal and vertical equations. Multiplication and division are performed before addition and subtraction.

+

-

=

6

×

+

+

+

×

=

62

-

×

-

÷

+

=

5

=

=

=

54

10

11

Solutions

ALLIES,
LEIVES,
RITUAL,
RIPPLE,
EDGEWORD

S	D	R	E	H
P	E	P	C	R
E	T	E	A	S
T	I	V	A	V
S	K	S	A	L

SXS

11		10		54		
=		=		=		
5	=	3	+	1	÷	2
		-		×		-
29	=	6	×	9	+	8
		+		+		×
9	=	5	-	4	+	7

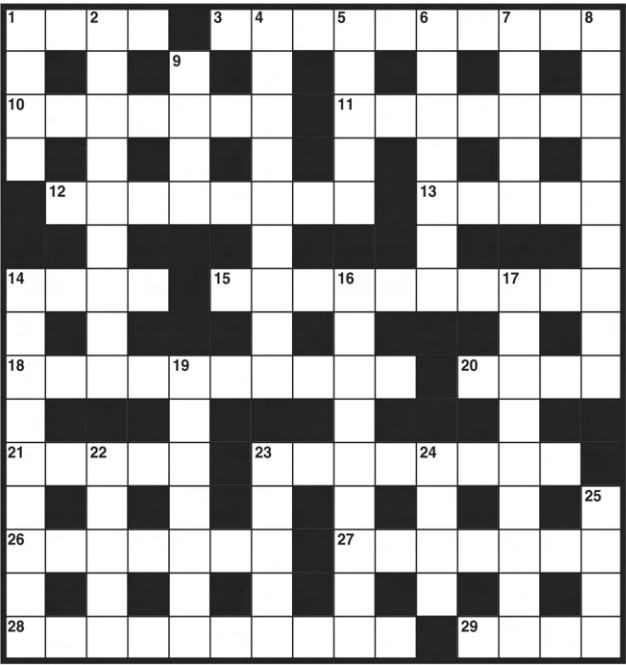
CROSSMATH

26-06-26 | PUZZLES AND PAGINATION © **pagemasters.**

WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER, THURSDAY, JUNE 25, 2026, 9

CROSSWORD

No. 184



ACROSS

- 1 Kitchenware (4)
3 AD (4,6)
10 Non-professional (7)
11 Japanese paper folding (7)
12 A sweet cold drink (8)
13 Excuse (5)

- 14 Spindle (4)
15 Agitated (10)
18 Gratification (10)
20 Duster (4)
21 Adage (5)
23 Ponder (8)
26 US state (7)

- 27 Pirate's sword (7)
28 Child of one's child (10)
29 Principal (4)
- DOWN**
- 1 Devout petition (4)
2 Journeyed (9)
4 Account of events (9)
5 Layer that absorbs most of the sun's UV radiation (5)
6 Largest of the Ryukyu islands, south of Japan (7)
7 Baghdad native (5)
8 Started (9)
9 Note (4)
14 Annoying (9)
16 Relating to a specific discipline (9)
17 Neighbour of Mexico (9)
19 Member of ancient Germanic tribe (7)
22 Country (5)
23 Collision of vehicles (5)
24 Very small amount (4)
25 Book ID (1,1,1,1)

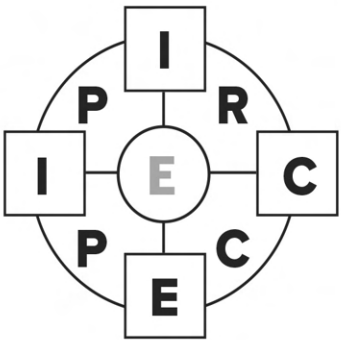


9-LETTER

No. 184

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

Today's Aim:
9 words: Good
13 words: Very good
18 words: Excellent

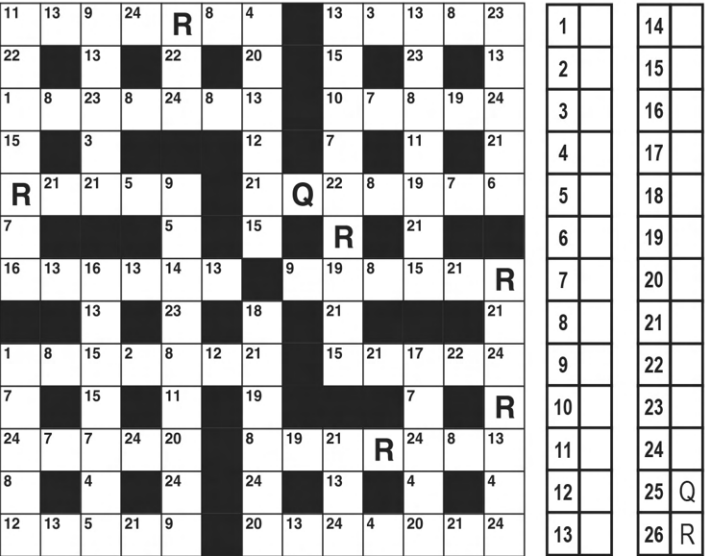


SOLUTION
price, recipe, rice, ripe
pipe, PRECIPICE, prep.
piece, pier, pierce, pipe,
epic, icier, peep, peer,
cere, creep, crepe.

CODEWORD

No. 134

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?

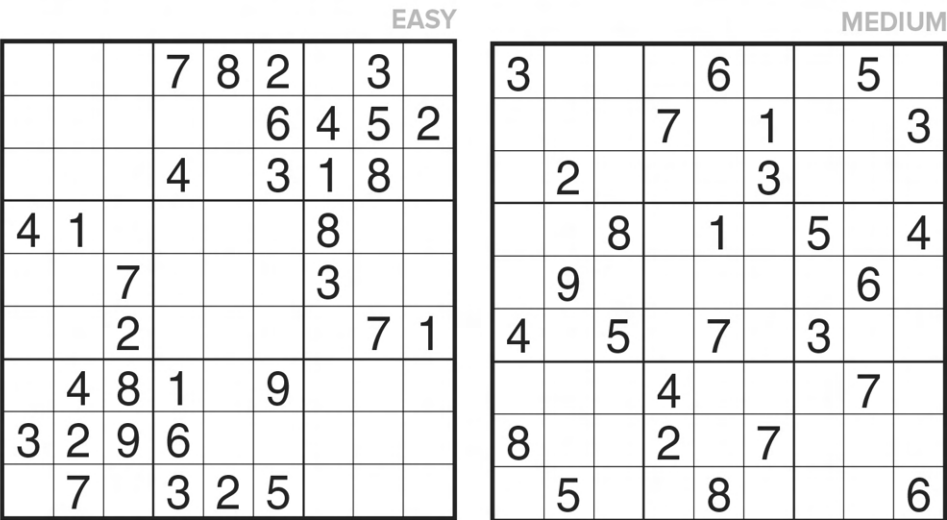


SOLUTIONS: 1=M, 2=W, 3=V, 4=C, 5=K, 6=X, 7=Q, 8=I, 9=S, 10=J, 11=G, 12=F, 13=A, 14=Y, 15=D, 16=P, 17=B, 18=Z, 19=N, 20=H, 21=E, 22=U, 23=L, 24=T

SUDOKU

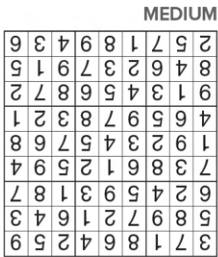
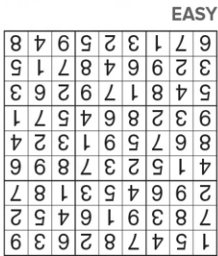
No. 184

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.



PUZZLES AND PAGINATION © **pagemasters.**

SOLUTIONS



QUICK QUIZ

- The Eisner Award is an award given in what field?
- How many people are currently in space?
- Ira Glass (pictured) hosts which weekly hour-long radio program?
- For what crime was a rooster put on trial in Switzerland in 1474?
- When translated to English, what does 'Timor Leste' mean?
- What tools do orangutans make for the purpose of communication?
- New Zealand's 2021 Smokefree legislation banned tobacco purchases for people born after what year?
- Which US energy company was declared bankrupt after a 2001 corporate fraud scandal?
- How many of the world's 25 most venomous snakes are native to Australia?
- What play's full title includes *A Trivial Comedy for Serious People*?



ANSWERS: 1. Comic books 2. 10 3. This American Life 4. For playing an egg 5. East 6. Whistles made from bundles of leaves 7. 2009 8. Enron 9. 21 10. The Importance of Being Earnest

WORDFIT

No. 094

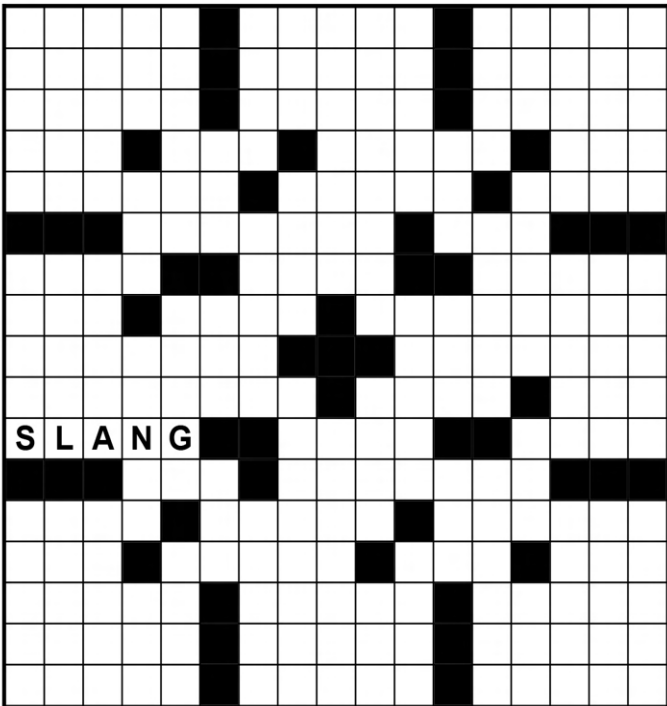
3 LETTERS

- ADD
ALL
AND
ANT
ART
DDT
DUE
EAR
EEL
EWE
EYE
FEW
GEM
HIP
LAY
NET
OAR
OWE
PEN
RUM
RYE
SAT
TAG
TOP

- MERE
MEWS
OVEN
RELY
TICK

5 LETTERS

- ABOVE
AGILE
ANGEL
AROMA
AWARE
BABES
BINGO
BLARE
BLURB
CHORE
CLEAR
DEBIT
DEBTS
DIMES
DRIED
EAGLE
EASED
EDGER
ELEGY
ERECT
ERODE
ERRED
GLIDE
GOADS
GOODY
IRATE
LEADS
LEGAL
OARED



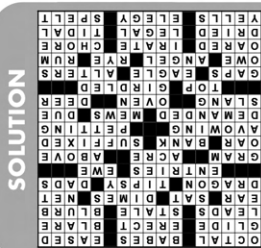
- OCTAL
OGLED
OXIDE
PERIL
RANGE
RAVEL
RURAL
SAUNA
SLANG
SMELT
SPELT
STALE
STEMS
TIARA

- TIDAL
TIPSY
UPEND
VENUE
WAFTS
WANTS
YELLS

- 7 LETTERS
AVOWING
BEADIER
ENTRIES
GIRDLED
PETTING
VILLAGE

- 8 LETTERS
DEMANDED
DOGGEREL
ECLIPSES
SUFFIXED

- 6 LETTERS
ALTERS
DRAGON
ELECTS
LESSON



WORD SEARCH

No. 094

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- ANGEL FOOD CAKE
APPLE CRUMBLE
APPLE PIE
BRULEE
CANNOLI
CLAFOUTIS
COOL WHIP
CROISSANT
DOUGHNUT
FONDANT
FRITTER
GELATO
JELLY
LADYFINGER
MADEIRA
MINCE PIE
PAVLOVA
PUDDING
RED VELVET
SAGO
SOUFFLE
STRUDEL
TAFFY
TART
TIRAMISU
TORTE
TREACLE
TRUFFLE

SECRET MESSAGE: Save room to satisfy your

sweet tooth

25-06-26

'ONE STOP SHOP' DIRECTORY

Raine&Horne.
Wellington

Residential, Commercial & Rural Sales
Latest Sales Marketing Technology
Personalised Service Tailored To Your Property Needs

Call 0428 459 830
Email gary.francis@wellington.rh.com.au

Gary Francis Multiple Recipient of Raine & Hornes' Prestigious Chairmans Club Awards



DOMESTIC WATER DELIVERIES



Servicing
WELLINGTON & REGION

Fiona: 0427 463 441
Ken: 0427 463 442

 **REDFERN**
HEAVY DIESEL

Lc No:
MVRL 60819

FOR ALL YOUR DIESEL NEEDS
Servicing Wellington & surrounding areas.

BART: 0427 724 788

 **T & N**
AUTO & AG SERVICES

For all mechanical needs

Car & 4wd Servicing
(new & old)
Road Worthy Inspection
Mechanical Repairs
Wheel Alignment
and Much More

Phn: 02 68 45 1112 92 Lee Street
0488 660 776 WELLINGTON

 **JUST HANG IT**

HAND-MADE BY SHARON WILSON
0407 935 998
Check out my facebook page

 **Peter Milling & Company**
Livestock & Property Agents

Are you thinking of selling your home?

Contact Rebecca at Peter Milling & Company and see why she was awarded the #1 agent of the year 6 years running!

 Rebecca Harding
Residential Sales Manager
P: 02 6845 1555
M: 0457 517 444

Is your business missing?
We can fix that!
Get your business in front of new customers

Phone Sharon on 0407 935 998

 **PATHWAY TO POTENTIAL**
SUPPORT SERVICE

NDIS SUPPORT PROVIDER
SERVICING DUBBO, WELLINGTON & NARROMINE NSW

CONTACT US  <http://pathwaytopotential.com.au>

Our Socials  

ARE YOU OR SOMEONE YOU KNOW LOOKING FOR A DISABILITY PROVIDER?



Straight to your email Each Thursday

Wellington & District
LEADER

digital edition

\$32 - 3 months - 13 edition * \$64 - 6 months - 26 edition
\$120 - 12 months - 49 editions

Contact: Sharon 0407 935 998 - Email: sharon@wdleader.news



AGRI TOPICS

Information for the Man on the Land

For More Information call



Mb: 0428 635 994

THIS WEEK will be much the same as last week – showery and cold. Mostly cloudy with light showers possible Saturday, Sunday, Tuesday and Wednesday.

TheH5N1 strain of avian influenza has been confirmed on mainland Australia for the first time, detected in a brown skua seabird in WA Cape Le Grand beach on June 20. Previously detected on remote Australian territories such as Heard Island and McDonald Islands where it killed over 13,000 elephant seal pups, highlighting its impact on wildlife. Globally, H5N1 has caused 1204 outbreaks in poultry, 6326 outbreaks in wildbirds and nine outbreaks in bovines between July 2025 and March 2026, with millions of poultry birds culled to prevent the spread.

PREVENTION MEASURES Biosecurity plans, reporting and monitoring. Vaccines: no commercial vaccine for humans currently available, however experimental vaccines being trialled. Vaccines for poultry are used selectively in some regions.

Key messages

1. H5N1 bird flu is highly pathogenic and affects birds, mammals and occasionally humans.
2. Human infections are rare and there is no sustained person to person transmission.
3. Individuals should avoid contact with sick or dead birds ,follow local health guides

Markets at a glance

WOOL.. EMI closed 1989 c/kg clean, up 10c, NMI 2061c/kg clean with only Melbourne and Sydney operating. 21,251 bales offered with 4% passed- in. On day 1 Merino fleece ranged from minus 15c to plus 37c while Melbourne crossbred MPG’s rose by 10c to 30c Trading remained varied on second day with Merino fleece MPGs moving between minus 25 and plus 17c. Crossbreds again led market higher, adding 5 to 33c in the south. With only one sale left for this season this season the market has posted remarkable gains. 12 months ago the EMI stood at 1207c and has risen 782c, an increase of 64.8%. In US dollar terms, the EMI has climbed from 784 US cents to 1045US cents a gain of 621US cents or 79.3 %

CATTLE.. CTLX 16th. 2748 head (+594) steers 498c to 632c and heifers jumped 10c, reaching 538c/kg. The limited supply of prime yearlings was mostly firm, making from 472c to 520c/kg. Feeder steers considerably dearer, light and middleweights 500c to 619c, heavy grown feeders to 564c/kg. Yearling steers to backgrounders dearer, 480c to 604c/kg. Heifers to feed unchanged, 472c to 545c/kg Restocker yearling heifers 440c to 545c/kg. Heavy grown steers firm, 430c to 520c/kg, heifers 402c to 488c/kg. 2&3 score cows to process a few cents better, 250c to 398c, restocker cows 370c to 386c/kg. Heavy cows to 426c/kg. 135 bulls 300c to 420c/kg

SHEEP.. CTLX 17th. 2150 sheep (+400) lambs 3850 (-1200). Light lambs to restockers \$220 to \$263, down \$10, Merino lambs \$140 to \$183. Medium and heavy trade lambs fully firm ave 1290 to 1305c/kg cwt. Heavy 23to 24kg \$283 to \$320. Heavy \$315 to \$330, extra heavy \$338 to \$341. Mutton numbers lifted and quality improved \$8 to \$10 dearer. First x ewes \$284 to \$340, medium Merino wethers \$133 to \$230, ave 820c/kg cw

Clearance sale continues.



Dubbo (02) 6885 0549



Wellington 0427 919 062

WEEKLY MARKET REPORT
Week ending June 19, 2026
AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week \$51/25	This Week M51/25	Last Sale \$50/25	Sydney Change	Last Year Sydney	Sydney Yearly Change
17	2761	2720	2752	+9	1663	+1098
18	2626	2628	2650	-24	1602	+1024
19	2429	2436	2428	+1	1533	+896
19.5	2340	2335	2340n	-	-	-
20	2251n	2250	-	-	1441n	+810
21	-	-	-	-	-	-
28	880n	862	850n	+30	460n	+420
MC	1264n	1224n	1229n	+35	701n	+563

Small offering holds prices firm

IN THE smallest national offering since June last year, the 21,251 bales catalogued resulted in another overall rise with only Sydney and Melbourne offering. Tuesday’s opening was a little erratic for Merino fleece in the North and firm to dearer in the South. Day two sales were softer in Sydney and firm to slightly weaker in Melbourne, with the varying price movements on those indicators suggesting buyers remained selective. Skirtings held their values for the week, cardings showed the greatest improvement in the North, whilst crossbreds continued to be well sought after, noticeably the 30-micron indicator rose 43 cents being the best indicator result of the sale. In US terms, the prior week’s EMI loss was all but recovered, and after a 10-cent rise the Australian EMI is getting ever closer to 2000 cents clean. The market does though appear to be entering a more balanced phase, with further gains becoming harder to achieve. As an industry, we tend to focus and follow the Merino indicators more closely than the others, but for the last three months crossbred prices have been performing exceptionally well. Between 2011 and 2019 they enjoyed a good run in terms of prices, followed by heavy losses in 2020 at the onset of the pandemic, and then continued to drift lower or trade at extremely low levels. It’s only 12 months ago that the improvement started, with last week’s price around double that value. Those historical values show the range in which they can trade, with the 28-micron indicator at a high of 1318 cents and a low of 290 cents in the past 10 years. Some buyers taking advantage of the low prices, purchased large quantities over that time. One buyer in particular bought that much that they needed to build more sheds to house it all. The price is being driven by demand now, rather than a cheap way to keep machinery running, with the finer types finding their way into 22.5-micron blends. In the domestic Chinese market there is good demand for wool/acrylic sweaters from these blends, with low numbers of these micron types worldwide, particularly in South America, keeping prices at almost 10-year highs. The broader crossbred’s wools find their way into knitted outerwear, very much suited to the cold winters experienced in the Northern Hemisphere. The final sale of the season this week with all three centres offering 27,700 bales, Macwool and Carmichael cataloguing 770.

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS



Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO Cattle.. 3522 yarded. Quality was very mixed compared to previous sale. Larger percentage of secondary crossbred cattle, still some good lines of well-bred and finished cattle. Usual buyers present, market held steady for quality lines, cheaper trend on secondary types. Middleweight yearling steers to feed and restock 448c to 658c/kg, heavy-weights 470 to 606c/kg. Heifer portion to feed 440 to 560c, processors paying 440c to 530c/kg. Grain fed finished bullocks 469 to 498c/kg. Grown heifers 410 to 486c/kg. Heavy finished cows 380 to 440c/kg, plainer cows 375 to 396c/kg.

Dubbo Lambs.. 9570. Rain held numbers back. A fair quality yarding, large numbers of secondary and plainer types. Odd pens of neat trade lambs and a few heavy weights. Lightweight lambs to processors \$6 dearer, 12kg to 18kg Merino \$151 to \$236. Trade and heavy lambs up to 28 kgs \$8 to \$10 dearer, extra heavy weights firm. 20kg to 24kg trade lambs \$250 to \$316, ave 1250c/kg cwt. 24kg to 30kg \$286 to \$368, over 30kg \$361 to \$388, ave 1145c/kg cwt. Merino lambs firm to \$5 dearer, trade weights \$227 to \$277, heavy weight Merinos to \$319. Lambs to restockers dearer, crossbreds back to paddock \$140 to \$271, feeders paid to \$265. Hoggets to

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Coonabarabran

SCONE BASED trainer Liam Ruddy who had his first runner in late December, won the opening race with Billabong on Saturday at Coonabarabran.

Relishing the heavy track conditions, Billabong (\$2.80) had Kody Nestor in the saddle when an over four lengths, all the way winner from Rubilicios (Mikayla Weir, \$11) and Parissident (Leanne Boyd, \$7) in the 900-metres Local Community Radio 2WCR FM Maiden Handicap.

Formerly from England, Liam Ruddy before gaining his trainers licence had been the Racing Manager for trainer Ciaron Maher, operator of arguably the biggest stable in Australia.

The Racing Manager position is now held by Sam Fitzgerald the former Manager of Dubbo Turf Club.

A big upset was averted when the well fancied Abated Breath lasted to beat rank outsider Sunset Drive in the 1200m Chris Cormie Gallop Maiden Plate.

The Brett Thompson, Gulgong/Wellington trained Abated Breath (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$3.80) shook off joint leader Meteor Mist, then held out the Robert Lane trained Sunset Drive (Nick Palmer, \$71) by a half-head with nine lengths to the third placed Field Of Hearts (Serg Lisnyy, \$21).

Coolah resident Derek Piper who trains his team at Mudgee won the 1600m Roachs Hardware Class 1 & Maiden Plate with Northern Exposure.

Himeros (Izzy Neale, \$10) held a good lead but was run down and beaten almost two lengths by Northern Exposure (Mikayla Weir, \$5) while the \$3.70 favourite Freedom To Roam (Ben Looker) wound up in third place.

In the placings at several recent starts, the Philip Duffy, Tamworth trained Northern Boogie was a deserved winner of the 900m Pincham Bros Subway Class 3 Handicap.

Producing a good run from behind the leaders, Northern Boogie (Ben Looker, \$3.20) raced away from Discreet Miss (Zoe Hunt, \$7.5) and Chapolicious (Mikayla Weir, \$1.50 fav).

The meeting was abandoned after five races but not before Mendooran trainer Jane Clement won the 1600m Korff and Co Dash with Hardy.

Given a nice run behind the leader Top Act, Hardy (Gabrielle Johnston, \$9) scored by a half-length from stablemate Oakfield Echidna (Billy Cray, \$10) and Mariota (Jasmine Urqahart-Warren, \$4.20).

The next meeting at Coonabarabran is Saturday, July 25.

Meanwhile, Dubbo to race next Sunday.



WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

Racing at Wellington Thursday August 13

Full TAB -7-race card

It’s a great day out!!

Become a Wellington Race Club Member and support local racing

12 THURSDAY, JUNE 25, 2026, WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

CSSA State Cross Country 2026. What an incredible opportunity for our students to represent our school at the CSSA State Cross Country, held at the Sydney International Equestrian Centre, Horsley Park.

After months of training, determination and perseverance, our students embraced the challenge of competing alongside students from Christian schools across NSW. We are so proud of the way they represented our school community, demonstrating courage, sportsmanship and resilience throughout the day.

We would also like to thank Dubbo Christian School for welcoming us to travel alongside their team and Tyndale Christian School for their generous hospitality. We greatly appreciated the kindness and support shown to our students throughout the trip.

Congratulations to all of our runners on reaching this level of competition. Whether achieving personal bests, overcoming nerves, or simply giving their very best effort, each student should be proud of their achievement.



Reported by:
Amy Woolfrey
Year 5/6 Teacher



Step Back in Time: Life in Ancient Jerusalem whole school devotion. Students and staff gathered for a whole-school assembly that took a journey back in time to explore what life was like in Jerusalem during the years when Jesus was growing up. Through an engaging skit performed by school staff (Mrs. Cassel, Mrs. White, and Miss Smith), students gained a deeper understanding of the daily experiences, customs, and culture of the people who lived during biblical times. The assembly was brought to life through interactive activities, including the opportunity to taste foods similar to those prepared and eaten in that era. This hands-on experience helped students connect with history in a meaningful way while deepening their understanding of Jesus' life and the world in which He lived.





Wellington Public School

Debate



Aubree, Darcy, Merindah and George represented our Kerri Parkes Western Challenge debating team in a challenging debate against Molong Central School. The team argued the affirmative case that all schools should be required to teach swimming from Kindergarten, presenting thoughtful and well-researched arguments. Molong Central School delivered a strong and persuasive negative case, making for a highly competitive debate. Congratulations to both teams on an excellent contest, with Molong Central School ultimately taking out the win. We are incredibly proud of our students for their preparation commitment throughout the debate.



Congratulations to the WPS Navy Blues and the WPS Sky Blues who both came away with a win in the second round of the Premier's Debating Challenge!

WPS hosted the Emus and Kangaroos teams from Bletchington Public School. All of the students from both schools did a great job structuring their arguments- the adjudicators certainly had a tricky task. The win has given confidence to the WPS teams who are looking forward to their next debates in week 10 of this term.





St Mary's Catholic School



MEET THE PAW-FECT MEMBER OF THE ST MARY'S TEAM!

Say hello to Dimble, St Mary's wonderful therapy dog and officially the most popular face on campus! Whether he is visiting classrooms, spending time with students in the playground or relaxing in the library, Dimble brings comfort, companionship and plenty of smiles to everyone he meets.

As an important part of student wellbeing at St Mary's, Dimble helps create a calm and positive learning environment. His gentle nature and friendly personality make him a welcome presence around the school, and students and staff alike appreciate the joy he brings each day.



Golfing News

Busy week on the course

ANOTHER BUSY week on the Wellington golf course with players utilising our wonderful greens and irrigated fairways nearly every day last week.

Last Saturday's 4BBB Aggregate Stableford and the semi-finals of the Kiss Trophy attracted plenty of players. Stableford winners were Steven McCarroll and Paul Hannelly who combined brilliantly to leave the field in their wake with their final score of 43pts.

Runners-up were Ben Kiss and Jeremy Barton who combined well to finish with 42pts.

Prize winners were Garry McNaughton-Ashley Bullock 41pts; Allison Brien-John Donnelly, Cody Conn-Ryan McCracken, William Hangan-David Naveau 40pts; Richard Agar-John Donnelly, Bryan Kiss-John Gersbach 38pts; Peter Payne-Cody Hannelly 37pts; Peter Holden-Elton Keeffe 36pts.

The Brent Eather Encouragement award was taken out by a couple of visitors from Yeoval John and Robert Christie who finished with a paltry 17pts, hope they still enjoyed themselves.

Wednesday's Individual Stroke winner was Janelle Frappell and by a fair margin too and the only one to break par as well, final score 71nett.

Runner up was Denise Haesler finishing with a 74nett on countback.

Prize winners were Wendy Slack-Smith, James Fleming 74netts; Marie Cornish 75nett.

Janelle Frappell and Denise Haesler claimed the first round of the WDLGA Medal.

Nearest the pin, Gae Drew and Denise Haesler.

Thursday's Individual Stableford winner was Nathan Stewart who cleaned up the field by a comfortable margin, final score 38pts. Runner-up was Joe Ryan with 34pts on c/b. Prize winners were Rod McMahon 34pts, Matt Ringland 33pts.

J and B Championship C grade semi-final: Gary Cusack will take on either Bryan Kiss or John Gersbach

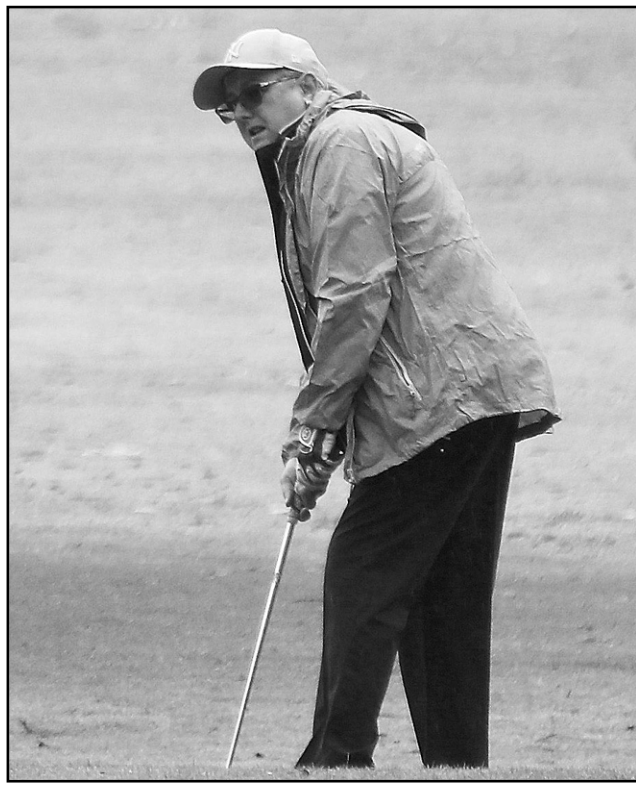
Draw for Round 1 of the Lion of Waterloo Trophy: Brent Eather-Wayne Lang v Kurt Cusack-David Hyde, Rod McMahon-Noel Stanford v John Donnelly-Robert Baker, David-Adam Ryan v Rod Pedron-Tim Parker, Jim-Reid Armstrong v David Naveau-Garry McNaughton, Malcolm Payne-Steve Kiss v Matt Reid-Lewis Stanley, Paul West-Rod Miller v Rod Irwin-David O'Brien, Denise Haesler-Wendy Slack-Smith v George Hollow-Gary Cusack, Jono Smith-Damien Bell v John Southwell-Doug Ney, Brock Naden-Drew Stone v Patrick Slack-Smith-Rob Parnell, Stephen Whiteman-Joe Ryan v Bye, Allison Brien-Richard Agar v Mitchell Cusack-Nathan Stewart, Peter Holden-John Gersbach v Bye, David Wilson-Michael Britton v Bye, Marie Cornish-Teena Hill v Bye, Ashley Bullock-David East v Bye, Elton Keeffe-Matt Ringland v Bye.

This match is to be played by July 11.

There are no more PREFERRED LIES.

This Saturday's event is Round 1 of the Joe Ryan Mowing RED TEE Winter Cup. Remember, this event is over three rounds with best two scores counting.

19th Hole



Janelle Frappell was last Wednesday's Individual Stroke winner.

CLUBS & COMMUNITY AWARDS

Education 2024 WINNER

Wellington Soldiers Club

Gamble Help is close at hand Gambleaware.nsw.gov.au | 1800 858858 | gambleaware.nsw.gov.au

ARTHUR STREET, WELLINGTON | INFORMATION FOR MEMBERS AND THEIR GUEST

WELLINGTON Soldiers Memorial Club

6845 2877

SCHOOL HOLIDAY BINGO WITH A TRIVIA TWIST

FREE

Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club Thursday 9th July 11 am

BINGO HIGH ROLLERS

LAST FRIDAY OF EVERY MONTH FROM 11.30AM

\$25 / BOOK

20 Games • \$50 Gift Cards
6x Line Games • \$25 Gift Cards
2x Under Cover Games
Free Book Raffle

MEMBERS BADGE DRAW

TUESDAY'S FRIDAY'S SUNDAY'S

The prize bank is growing! Don't miss out!
You must be at the Club to Win!

CASH FEVER FRIDAY'S SUNDAY'S

DRAWN AFTER THE RAFFLES

COUNTRY MUSIC

— darling —

CLANCY PYE

— at the club —

SATURDAY 4TH JULY

— 7:30PM —

WELLINGTON Soldiers Memorial & Golf Group

GREG HUSH

Live MUSIC

SATURDAY 27TH JUNE STARTS FROM 7.30PM